

10.3 Combining classes

It is possible to combine classes. This functionality provides real power when it comes to reusing elements. For example, you can use a containing element as often as you want, but you may not always want the elements it contains to be displayed in the same way. So, you could make several versions of the containing element and set the unique properties for each, but why would you want to repeat the margin, padding, and background styles for each and end up with more class names to worry about? This is where combined classes are really useful. Now, if you wanted an `<h3>` inside a particular container to have a red background, you might create the following styles:

```
h3 {  
font-size:110%;  
margin:10px 5px 10px 5px;  
padding:5px;  
}  
.custom_background {  
background-color:#F00;  
}
```

You might then call that as follows:

```
<div class="container">  
<h2>Latest News</h2>  
<h3 class="custom_background">Man found in vase</h3>  
content  
</div>
```

No! This is extra markup forced to use a class attribute with each heading to define its colour. Instead, create unique selectors for each section, keeping the existing `<h3>` declaration, and then creating a set of background styles with semantically meaningful names:

```
.news h3{  
background:#F00;  
}  
.entertainment h3{  
background:#666;  
}  
.sport h3{  
font-size:110%;  
background:#CCC;
```